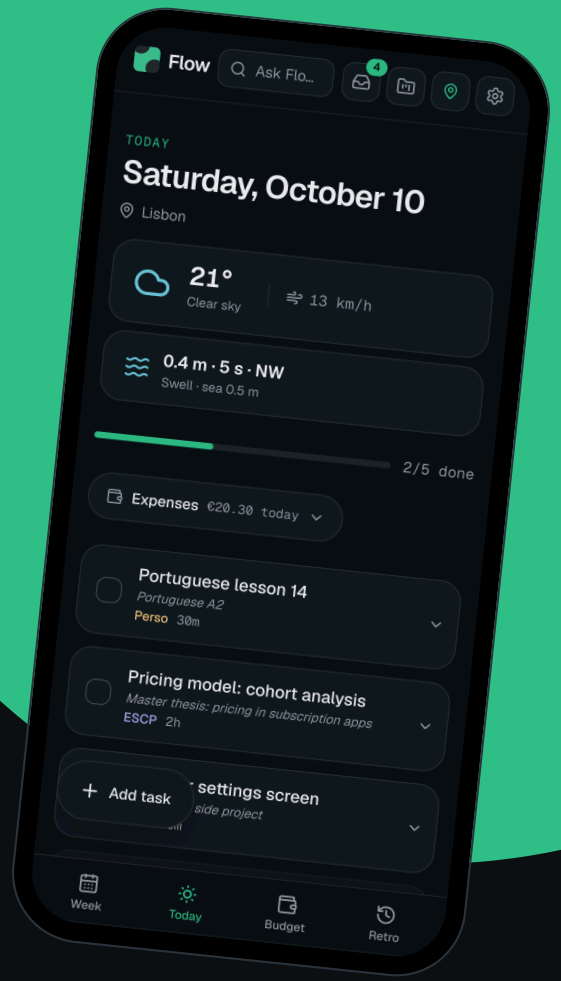
Product case study · 2026

Flow.

Long-term work, made visible and doable day by day. Plus a budget that finally makes sense.

Designed and specified by me as Product Owner, implemented with AI coding agents (Claude Code), shipped in a month.



● Real app · demo data

Source code is private · this deck shows the product, architecture and key decisions

01 The problem

Long-term work is invisible in day-to-day tools.

0h

To-do lists only show what's due

A thesis or a side project never becomes "today's task" until it's already urgent.

?h free

Plans ignore real free time

Classes, routines, trips across time zones: nobody computes the hours that are actually left.

€ £ $

Money is all over the place

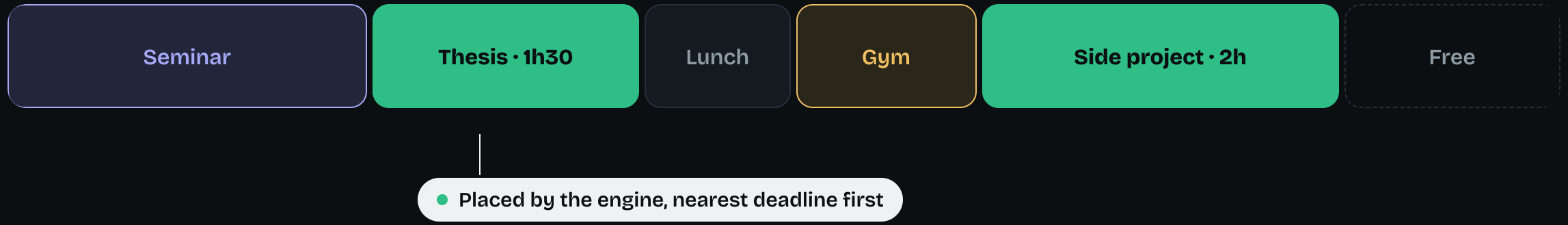
Expenses in several currencies and countries, and no clear picture of the month.

User #1: me. Master's student with side projects in parallel, always traveling. Every build tested daily on a real iPhone.

02 The idea

Treat projects as minutes, and pour them into real free time.

A Tuesday



Debt, with a date.

What doesn't fit becomes visible debt, with the date the project would slip.

Expenses in 2 taps.

Amount, category, done. Right currency, right country, right month.

AI proposes. I decide.

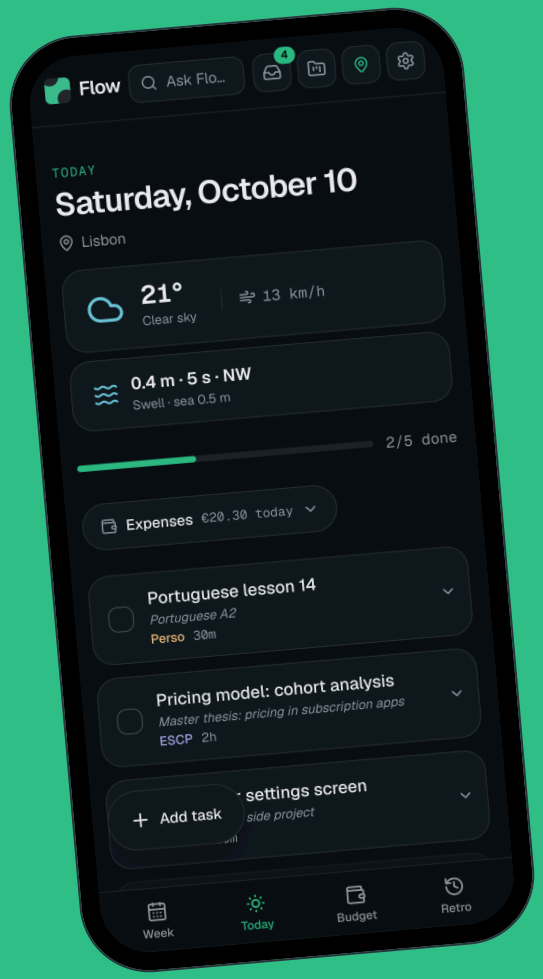
The assistant and booking emails only suggest. Nothing they propose is saved without a tap.

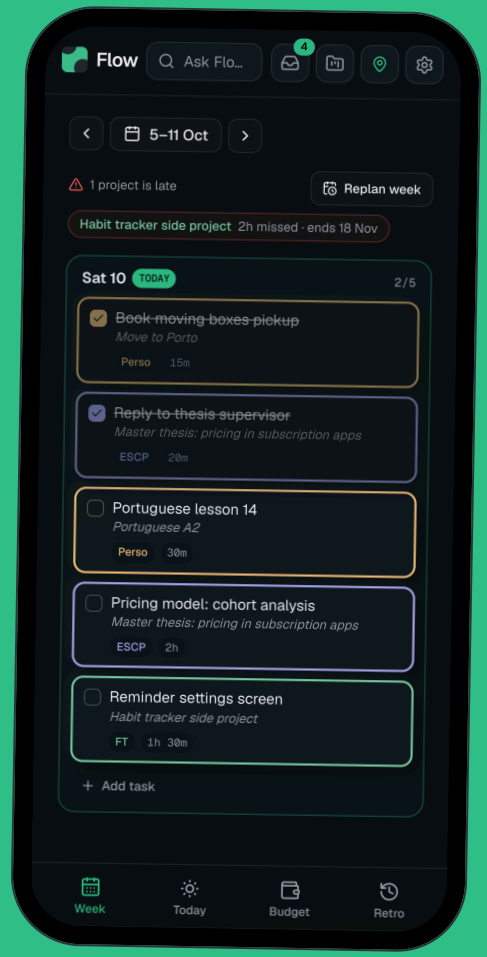
03 Plan the week

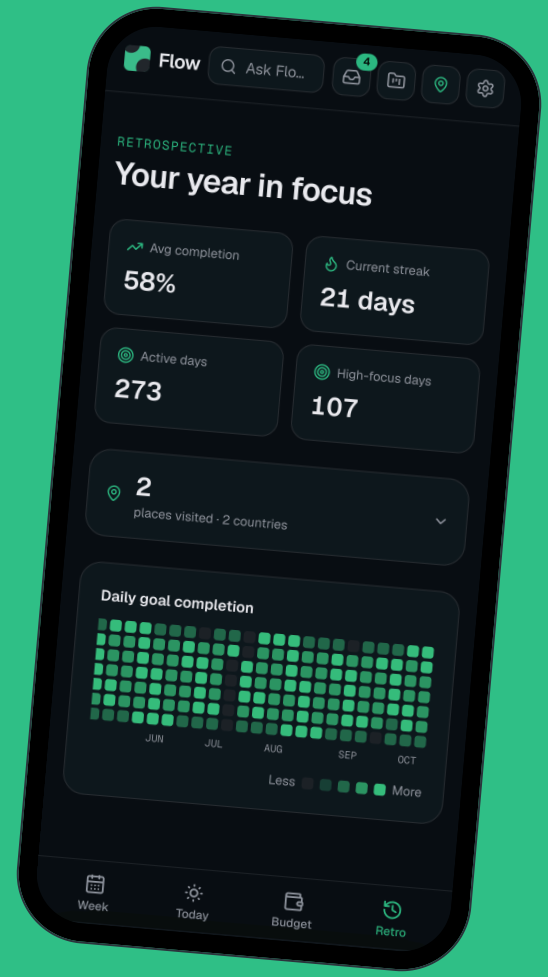
Today · Week · Retro

Retro: simulated one-year history to show the long-term view

- Capacity is computed, not guessed
- Late projects get a slip date





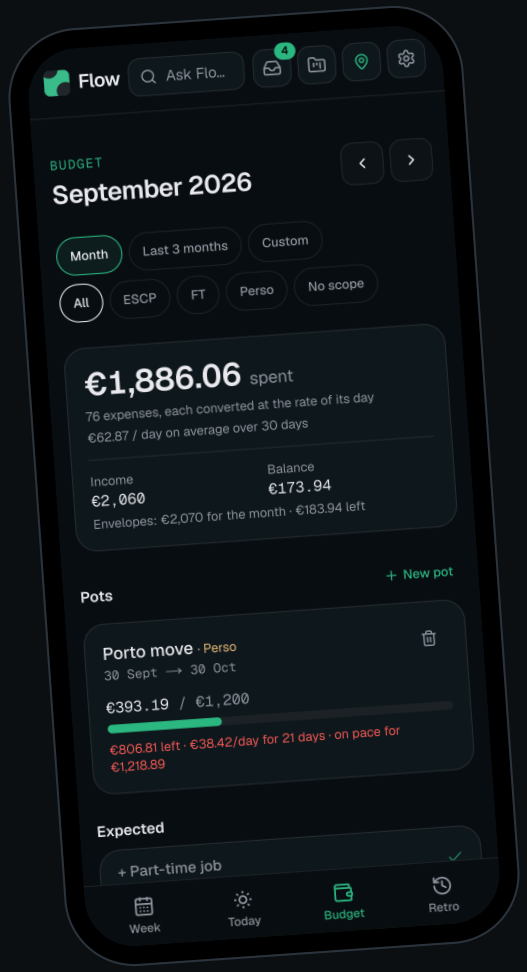


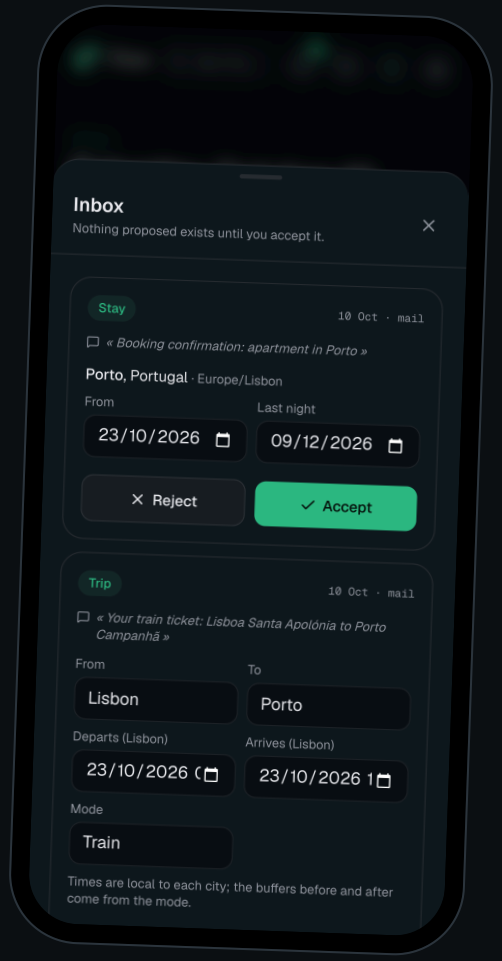
04 Money & capture

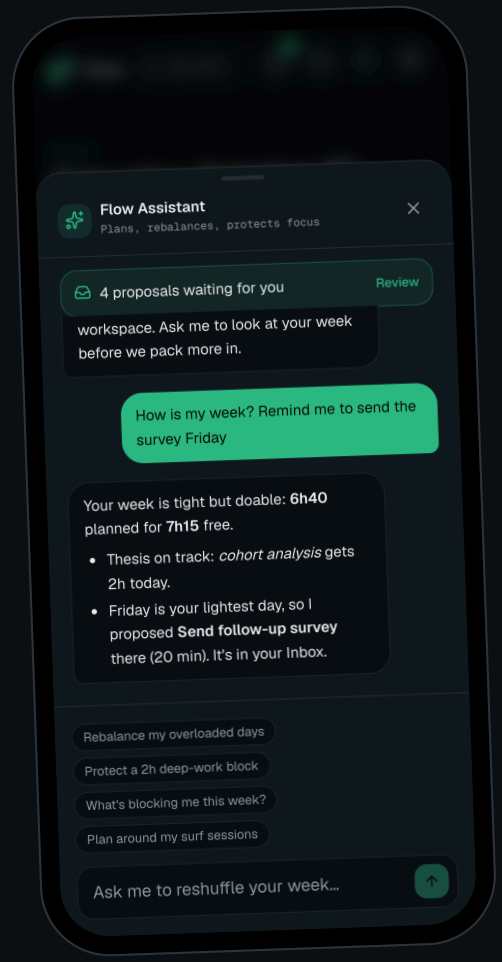
Budget · Inbox · Assistant

Gemini-powered assistant, shown here on demo data

- Booking email → trip + stay + expense
- Created only after my OK

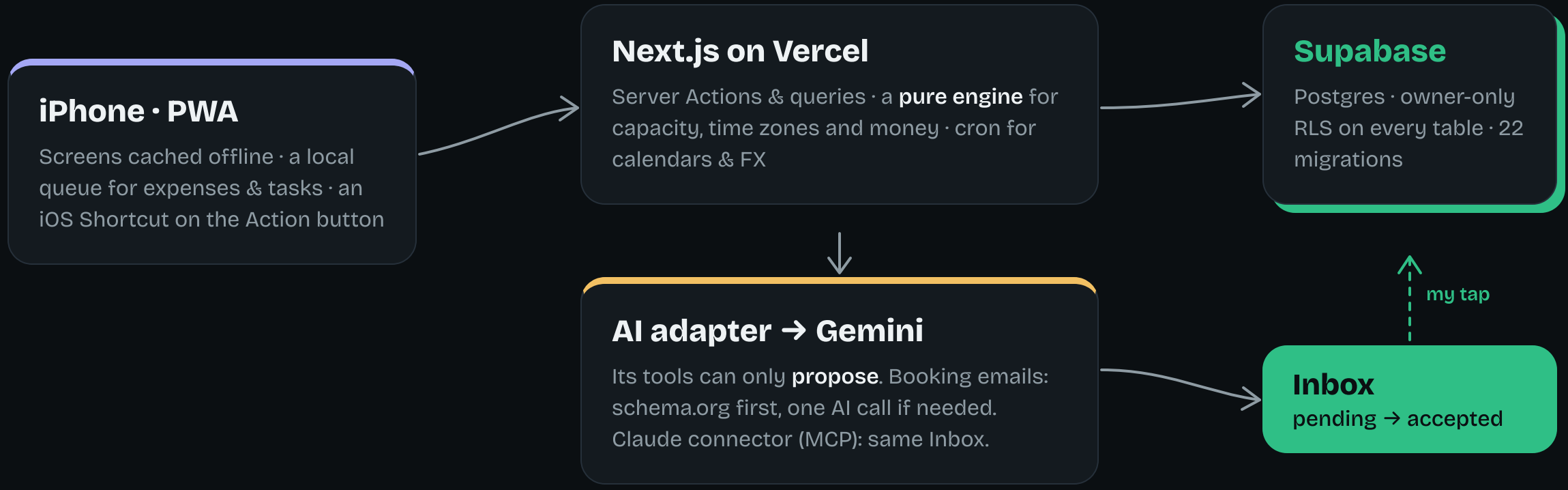






05 Under the hood

One app. AI on the server. Every row locked to its owner.



06 6 of 34 written decisions

Every choice has a cost, written down.

AI

AI proposes, I validate

Every AI proposal goes through an Inbox. **Cost:** one extra tap. **Win:** zero silent mistakes.

Planning

Capacity, not lists

Projects are minutes spread to their deadline. **Cost:** estimating hours. **Win:** delays get a date.

Capture

Emails without an agent

Structured data first, one AI call max, rules in code. **Cost:** less magic. **Win:** free and predictable.

Money

Rate frozen per day

Each expense stores its day's rate in €. **Cost:** more data per row. **Win:** past months never drift.

Offline

Offline where it counts

Only 3 actions queue offline, with no duplicates. **Cost:** limited surface. **Win:** simple and reliable.

Process

Real environments, solo

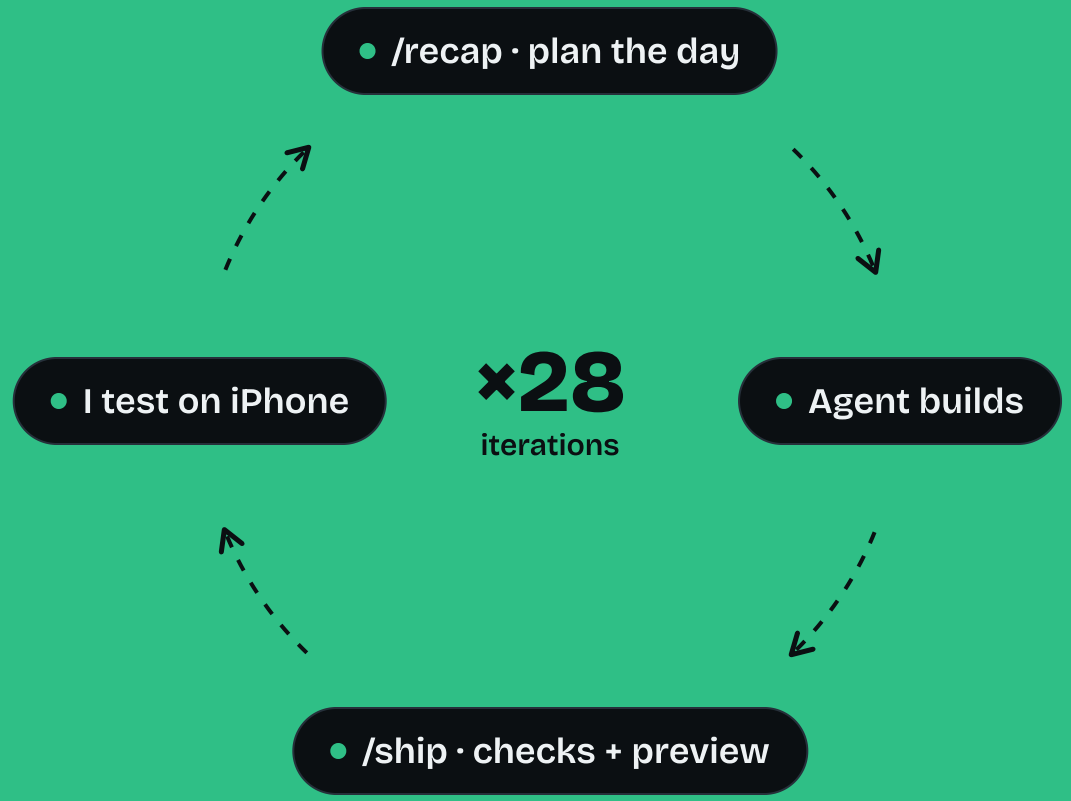
Preview per iteration, dev/prod split, I merge. **Cost:** more process. **Win:** ship daily, safely.

07 How it's built

AI agents write the code. I own the product.

Me, as Product Owner: vision, roadmap cut into iterations, acceptance criteria, testing every build on my phone, the call to ship.

Claude Code, as the dev team: framed by a written contract: architecture rules, actions it may never take (secrets, production, unapproved migrations, out-of-scope refactors), and a "limits" log instead of silent scope creep.



08 Roadmap

What the next iterations deliver.

NOW

Close budget & capture

Validate stays, the full expense list and expense places; finish a screen-by-screen pass that strips generic “AI app” UI.

NEXT · UNIFIED RETRO

One view of progress

A retro score based on long-term progress; time and money debt with their projections side by side; a calendar-year heatmap (Jan → Dec).

LATER

Journaling, then anticipation

Daily notes feeding the retro, then an agent that spots conflicts (a deadline vs. a trip) before they happen, still as proposals.

BACKLOG

Ideas, not yet scoped

Project history · lightweight reminders · trips detected from the calendar · document links on tasks · automatic arrival times.

M0 · Cleanup
6 iterations · done

M1 · Flow core
8 iterations · done

M2 · Budget & capture
14 iterations · closing

M3 · Unified retro
next

M4 · Journaling
later

Horizon
anticipation agent

Each item becomes an iteration: acceptance criteria first, then one branch, one live preview and my validation.

09 1 month in numbers

From first prototype to daily use.

28 iterations in 30 days

34 pull requests

134 tests

34 decisions

22 migrations

Sep 12 → Oct 11, 2026. 24 iterations validated against their criteria, 3 in production awaiting validation, 1 in progress. Every release goes through a live preview on my iPhone.

Next.js 16 · TypeScript · Supabase · Tailwind · Gemini · Vercel · github.com/neoanvroin-eng/flow-showcase